



men's hockey team extended its golden run, successfully defending its Asian Champions Trophy title. Coach Craig Fulton retained 10 players and three reserves from the squad that competed in Paris, integrating promising young talent to strengthen the team further.

Harmanpreet once again led from the front, scoring seven goals. Valuable contributions came from Uttam Singh (4), Raj Kumar Pal (3), Araiyeet Singh Hundal (3), and Sukhjeet Singh (3).

In goal, Krishan Pathak and Suraj Karkera admirably filled the void left by Sreejesh, conceding only five goals across the tournament while seamlessly rotating between matches.

Stalwarts bid farewell

In October, the 'queen of Indian hockey,' Rani Rampal, announced her retirement, bringing an end to an illustrious 16-year career. Since making her debut in 2008, the former captain played pivotal roles in India's Asian Games medal-winning campaigns in 2014 and 2018.

Rani was also a senior member of the history-making team that finished fourth at the Tokyo Olympics, a performance highlighted by its stunning quarterfinal victory over tournament favourite Australia.

However, Rani's journey with hockey is far from over. She will return to the field, this time as a coach, after being named the Indian coach and mentor of the Soorma

Trophy stays home: The Indian women registered a 1-0 win over China in the final to successfully defend the Asian Champions Trophy at the Rajgir Sports Complex in Bihar. R. V. MOORTHY

Hockey Club women's team for the Hockey India League 2024-25 season.

Earlier in the year, defender and penalty corner specialist Deep Grace Ekka also bid farewell to the sport after over 12 years of being a cornerstone of the Indian team's defence.

Young guns dazzle

The Indian junior men's hockey team, led by newly appointed head coach Sreejesh, secured the bronze